Step-by-Step Guide to the Shared Sample Roast Room

Pang Khon Ridge Coffee Growers' Association, Mueang Chiang Rai · Ref. PKR-GD-11, version 2 · Issued 14 September 2026

The Association's Sample Roast Room (Room B3, ground floor of the Association building in Ban Pang Khon) lets member farmers roast small samples of their own green coffee and have them cupped before they agree a sale price with a buyer. It replaces version 1 of August 2025.

1. Before you book

- **Membership.** Only members whose dues for the 2026/27 season are paid may book. Annual dues are 1,200 baht and are due by 31 October 2026. The Treasurer keeps the list of paid-up members and the Steward checks it before confirming a booking.
- **Induction.** Every user must complete the Roast Room Induction before the first booking. The induction lasts 2 hours and is held on the first Saturday of each month at 9:00. It remains valid for 24 months.
- **Green coffee condition.** Beans must be hulled and hand-sorted, with stones and husk removed. Moisture content must be between 10.0% and 12.0%. Test your lot on the moisture meter at the reception desk; the test is free. Lots above 12.0% are refused and must be dried further. Until 31 August 2026 the upper limit was 12.5%.

2. Booking a slot

Book through the LINE group "PKR Roast Room" or in the paper booking book at reception, at least 2 days before the slot. The room is open Tuesday to Saturday. Each slot lasts 90 minutes and starts at 8:30, 10:00, 13:00 or 14:30. A member may hold at most 2 slots per calendar week. During the harvest peak, from 1 December to 28 February, the limit is 1 slot per member per week so that more farmers can use the room.

The drum sample roaster (unit SR-1) takes batches of 300 g to 1 kg of green coffee. Use of the roaster costs 60 baht per batch; until 30 June 2026 the charge was 45 baht per batch. Cupping by the Head Cupper costs 150 baht per sample. Charges are added to your member account and deducted from your next parchment or green coffee payment. Cancel at least 24 hours before the slot; a late cancellation or a no-show is charged 100 baht.

3. On roast day, step by step

1. Sign in with the Roast Room Steward. The Steward opens the main gas valve and lights the pilot flame. Members never open or close the main gas valve themselves.
2. Weigh each batch of green coffee on the bench scale and write the lot code (farm code, picking date), the batch weight and the moisture reading in the Roast Log.
3. Preheat the SR-1 for 20 minutes until the drum reaches the charge temperature of 200 °C.

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4. Charge the beans and watch the colour. First crack usually starts after 9 to 10 minutes. For a sample roast, drop the beans 1 minute 30 seconds to 2 minutes after first crack begins.
5. Drop the beans into the cooling tray and keep the stirring arm running until they are cool to the touch, within 4 minutes.
6. Empty the chaff collector after every batch. This is the member's job, not the Steward's.
7. Weigh the roasted beans and record the weight loss in the Roast Log. A normal sample roast loses 13% to 16% of its green weight; batches that lose more than 18% are flagged for the Head Cupper.
8. Bag each batch and label it with the lot code, roast date and your member number.

Chaff fire. If smoke comes from the chaff collector, switch off the burner, keep the drum turning, do not open the collector, and call the Steward at once. The extinguisher hangs beside the door. A member involved in a chaff fire must repeat the induction before the next booking.

At the end of each day the Steward checks the chaff collector and closes the gas. Every Friday after the last slot the Steward also cleans the roaster's chimney and exhaust fan, so the 14:30 Friday slot ends at 15:30 instead of 16:00.

4. Cupping your samples

Rest roasted samples for at least 8 hours and no more than 72 hours before cupping. Cupping sessions are held every Thursday at 13:30. Leave 100 g of each sample on the Cupping Shelf in Room B3 by 16:00 on the Wednesday before. Each member may submit up to 4 samples per session; extra samples wait for the following week.

The Head Cupper scores each sample on the Association's 100-point cupping form. Results are placed in your pigeonhole and posted in the LINE group by 12:00 on Friday. A lot that scores 84 points or more may be put forward for the Association's Ridge Reserve buyer list; lots scoring 80 to 83.75 points are listed as Ridge Select. The Head Cupper decides which lots are put forward.

5. Taking coffee home and clearing up

- The room is for samples only. A member may take home up to 2 kg of roasted coffee per calendar month for household use. Coffee roasted in the room may not be sold; commercial roasting is booked separately through the Marketing Office.
- Remove all your green and roasted coffee on the day. Anything left in the room after 16:30 is moved to the lost-and-found shelf at reception and thrown away after 7 days.

6. Who to contact

- **Malai Mueangkham, Roast Room Steward** (ext. 213): bookings, gas, cleaning, equipment faults and the Roast Log.
- **Anucha Saiyalak, Head Cupper** (ext. 215): cupping sessions, scores, flagged batches and Ridge Reserve recommendations.
- **Sudarat Wongkhiao, Treasurer** (ext. 202): dues, account statements and disputes about roast or cupping charges. Disputes must be raised within 30 days of the statement date.

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